Delhi flight, and to meet him there before his departure for Bombay the same night.

When I reached Trivandrum, a pal of gloom hung in the air. The aircraft ladder operator Kutty told me in a choked voice that Prof. Sarabhai was no more. He had passed away a few hours ago, fol owing a cardiac arrest. I was shocked to the core; it had happened within an hour of our conversation. It was a great blow to me and a huge loss to Indian science. That night passed in preparations for airlifting Prof. Sarabhai's body for the cremation in Ahmedabad.

For five years, between 1966 to 1971, about 22 scientists and engineers had worked closely with Prof. Sarabhai. Al of them were later to take charge of important scientific projects. Not only was Prof. Sarabhai a great scientist, but also a great leader. I stil remember him reviewing the bi-monthly progress of the design projects of SLV-3 in June 1970. Presentations on Stages I to IV were arranged. The first three presentations went through smoothly. Mine was the last presentation. I introduced five of my team members who had contributed in various ways to the design. To everybody's surprise, each of them